# Land Science Student Research Project

## Science

**May, 2026**

Ollscoil Teicneolaíochta an Oirdheiscirt
South East Technological University

# Land Science Student Research Project (A32004)

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| **Short Title:** | Land Science Research Project |
| **Faculty** | Science and Computing |
| **Department** | Science |
| **Cluster** | Placement and Projects |
| **Author** | KMURPHY |
| **Credits** | 10 |

**Level:** Advanced

## Description of Module / Aims

This module consists of a research and development project, which aims to give students the facility to plan and carry out a programme of work based significantly on their own initiative. The student project will be carried out in semester 2, following on from a literature review on their chosen topic in the 1st semester. The projects will be carried out under the supervision of individual members of the academic staff within WIT/Kildalton, or with outside co-operators. As part of the module students will be introduced to techniques that are necessary in a research environment, such as choosing the correct experimental design and data management and analysis techniques for their chosen specialised research topic. This will culminate in the production of a written 'mini-thesis' on this research topic.

## Programmes

| | | |
|---|---|---|
| `SCIE-0071` | BSc (Hons) in Agricultural Science (`WD_SAGRI_B`) | 4 / 8 / M |
| `SCIE-0071` | BSc (Hons) in Land Management (in Agriculture) (`WD_SBSAG_B`) | 1 / 2 / M |
| `SCIE-0071` | BSc (Hons) in Land Management (in Forestry) (`WD_SBSFO_B`) | 1 / 2 / M |
| `SCIE-0071` | BSc (Hons) in Land Management (in Horticulture) (`WD_SBSHO_B`) | 1 / 2 / M |

## Indicative Content

- Experimental design
- Project work
- Written report on project
- Interpretation and critical evaluation of results in the context of the relevant scientific literature
- Presentation of report at seminar and oral

## Learning Outcomes

*On successful completion of this module, a student will be able to:*

1. Design and conduct a detailed field-based, laboratory-based, or desktop-based research project.
2. Produce a comprehensive and referenced scientific report.
3. Prepare a set of coherent results and analyse the data.
4. Produce a presentation justifying a thorough understanding of their research methodologies.

## Learning and Teaching Methods

- Field-based practical work.
- Laboratory-based practical work.
- Preparation of scientific report.
- Thesis.
- Oral presentations.

## Assessment Methods

| | Weighing | Outcomes Assessed |
|---|---|---|
| Continuous Assessment | 100% | |
| *Project* | 80% | 1,2,3 |
| *Presentation* | 20% | 4 |

## Assessment Criteria

**<40%:** Very limited knowledge and understanding of the subject matter. Failure to meet the objectives of the project. Unable to carry out or submit independent study and research.

**40%-49%:** Adequate level of research work performed in terms of quality and quantity of research output. Adequate standard and knowledge of research topic evident through fair report writing and oral presentation skills.

**50%-59%:** As well as the above, the student will display a good level of research work performed, in terms of quality and quantity of research output. Good standard and knowledge of research topic evident through good report writing and oral presentation skills, supplemented by an ability to present this knowledge in a clear and concise manner.

**60%-69%:** In addition to the above, the student will demonstrate a very high level of research work performed in terms of quality and quantity of research output. High standard and knowledge of research topic evident through very good report writing and oral presentation skills, supplemented by an ability to present this knowledge to a high technical standard.

**70%-100%:** All previous to an excellent level. In addition, the student will demonstrate an extensive level of research work performed, in terms of quality and quantity of research output. Excellent standard and knowledge of research topic evident through superior report writing and oral presentation skills, supplemented by an ability to present this knowledge to a very high technical standard.

## Learning Modes

| Learning Mode | F/T Hours | P/T Hours |
|---|---|---|
| Tutorial | 12 | |
| Practical | 108 | |
| Independent Learning | 150 | |

## Essential Material

- Bell, J. and S. Walters. _Doing Your Research Project; A guide for first-time researchers_. 6th ed. UK: Open University, 2014.
- Various, A. _Research papers and references_. Anywhere: Various, Various.

## Supplementary Material

- "ScienceDirect." www.sciencedirect.com. https://ezproxy.wit.ie/login?url=http://www.sciencedirect.com/
- "Web of Science." www.heanet.ie. http://www.heanet.ie/

## Requested Resources

- Room Type: Biology Lab

- Room Type: Chemistry Lab
- Room Type: Computer Lab